



Assuredly, the Braves didn't need the rain to put them into the All-Star classic but that was the anticlimax to a great big day of July 3. Then the Braves won, the Saints of St. Paul had lost and as midnight approached and the presses were ready to roll, Denver had beaten Omaha 10 to 8 in the eighth. The Braves at 10 p.m., Wichita time, had received the welcome news of Juan Pizarro's coming. All that was needed was the Omaha defeat.

Well, it didn't come and so, the headlines had to be rewritten. But everyone knew Wichita would win anyway, not even counting on the rain, surely a tough break

for Indianapolis which with its home-owned franchise could use a big holiday crowd.

What Will It Draw?

All spring and summer, the Doubting Thomases said it wasn't in the cards for Wichita to win the plums. Wichita had next to the smallest park in the league and a luke-warm set of fans, the critics from the other seven cities quipped. And so, they argued, why shouldn't St. Paul with its big park get the game? Or Minneapolis?

But the Braves survived that dismal road trip in June to Denver and Omaha, five defeats in six starts, and came back with a fine rush, winning 14 out of 18, and that did it.

It can be safely said Wichita will not approach the high attendance mark for an Association All-Star, that's impossible with the present quarters, but it isn't likely that a low mark will be had either.

The Association All-Star game was born in the deep depression, 1934, and the first game at Minneapolis drew 7,436. Andy Cohen, present Indianapolis manager, played in it. The high mark was last year, when Denver drew a tremendous 19,769.

The lightest crowd was, you'd never guess it, at Milwaukee. That was in 1936 when the game drew but 4,706. Wichita should double that, but we can't be sure just what will happen. It's something brand new and it may go big and it may not, frankly speaking.

There have been fine turnouts. Columbus had 12,269 in 1937; Indianapolis had in 1938 almost exactly the same, 12,277. Kansas City in 1939 had the All-Star game and packed in 16,551. Phil Rizzuto played for the Blues. So did DiMaggio, but it was not Joe, a brother, maybe Vince. Kansas City had even more in 1940, when 19,499 came to see.

But the game fell off 8,000 in a year, as Minneapolis drew but 10,127 in 1941 and Kansas City only 8,127 in 1942. But that was a war year, transportation drastically curtailed. Milwaukee had it in 1944, drawing 12,964, another wartime crowd. After 1946, at Indianapolis, the game was called off for eight years. It was resumed in 1954 at Indianapolis, drawing 10,948, about what it did in the same spot in 1946.

Minneapolis, in its old park, drew but 6,905 in 1955.

So, Wichita has all kinds of standards.

If the weather is good, a capacity turnout of 9,000 MIGHT be had. It's about all that can be hoped for, and that would be much below the average. But if the stands are comfortably filled it would at least point out the need of a new, larger and more up to date park here. That is one prime reason for a whopping good crowd. Another is that it could possibly save Triple A baseball here for 1958.

Slugging Match Again?

Many all-star games in the association have been slugfests. Scores of 13 to 6; 9 to 8; 19 to 7; 18 to 0; 16 to 6 and 10 to 5 are listed in the book.

But there has been some good pitching seen too, 3 to 2 in 1954, when Ted Wilks hurled part of it and Herb Score started; 4 to 3; 5 to 3, and 6 to 1.

Big league all-star rules prevail with at least six pitchers and lots of subs to be seen. It's a bargain way of seeing the big stars, some soon to be major league stars.

Yankees Split With Red Sox

NEW YORK, July 4 (AP)—Don Larsen pitched the New York Yankees to a split in their doubleheader with Boston today, winning the second game 4-1 after pinch hitter Mickey Vernon's two-run homer with two out in the ninth had given the Red Sox a 3-2 triumph in the opener.

A crowd of 52,791, second largest of the season here, saw Larsen yield only five hits for his fourth victory as he turned in his second successive complete game after failing to go the distance in any of his previous starts this season.

The holiday-minded spectators, who had come to Yankee Stadium hopeful of watching the Yankees extend their seven-game winning streak, were as chagrined as Yankee manager Casey Stengel when Bob Grim, his ace relief pitcher, threw the home run ball to Vernon that took an almost certain victory away from Bobby Shantz.

Grim was summoned from the bullpen by Stengel to pitch the ninth after the 140-pound Shantz had been forced to bow out for a pinch hitter in the eighth because of the intense heat. The Yankees were leading 2-1 at the time as a result of Bill Skowron's tie-breaking homer in the seventh and Mickey Mantle's spectacular catch of Dick Gernert's long drive with Ted Williams on base in the eighth.

Fans Jensen

Grim struck out the dangerous Jackie Jensen, gave up a single to Frank Malzone and seemed bent on insuring Shantz' 10th victory when he fanned pinch hitter Gene Stephens for the second out. But Vernon, batting for Sammy White, lofted his second pitch into the right field stands to score Malzone ahead of him for the tying and winning runs.

Vernon's wallop enabled Boston starter Dave Sisler to gain his seventh success of the season as well as to maintain his perfect record against the Yankees. The bespectacled righthander owns five victories over them, including three this year.

Boston used three pitchers in the second game with Dean Stone, the starter, charged with the loss. The veteran lefthander gave up only three hits before giving way to Bob Porterfield in the fifth but the Yankees stung him for three runs to hand him his third defeat against one victory.

BOSTON					NEW YORK				
P	AB	R	H	E	P	AB	R	H	E
Pierall	4	0	1	0	Kubek	3b	4	1	2
Klaus	ss	4	0	1	Skowron	1b	4	0	0
Williams	lf	4	0	1	Gernert	cf	4	0	0
Consolo	3b	0	0	0	Berra	c	4	0	0
Gernert	1b	4	1	1	Skowron	2b	4	0	0
Jensen	rf	3	0	0	Bauer	rf	2	0	0
Malzone	ss	3	0	0	McDonald	cf	2	0	0
Stephens	lf	3	0	0	Richon	3b	2	0	0
White	cf	3	0	0	Shantz	p	2	0	0
Sisler	p	4	0	0	A. Simmons	cf	2	0	0
Daley	c	0	0	0	Grim	p	0	0	0
Delock	p	0	0	0					

Totals 23 3 7 Totals 26 3 1
A—Lined out for Shantz in 8th.
B—Struck out by Shantz in 8th.
C—Homered for White in 8th.
Boston..... 100 002-3
New York..... 000 100 100-2
E—None. *Rich-Gernert, Vernon, Skowron, Skowron, DP—Lecio, Klaus and Gernert, Klaus, Consolo and Gernert, Shantz, McDonald and Richon. Left—Boston 7, New York 3. RB—Sisler 3, Delock 1, Shantz 4, SO—